KenTender: One Connected Record, From Strategy to Award

Oct 5, 2026

KenTender is a complete public procurement system for a Kenyan procuring entity. It covers the whole cycle in one place: the strategy a purchase serves, the departments' needs, the budget, the annual procurement plan, requisitions, tenders, the supplier portal, bid opening, evaluation and award. Contract management comes next in the same chain.

KenTender is built to digitise the full procurement and contract management lifecycle; to make procurement more efficient and effective; to enforce compliance with procurement law; to make every decision transparent, traceable and auditable; to reduce the room for corruption and malpractice; and to align procurement with national development goals. The journey below shows where each module delivers on those aims.

What makes it more than a set of forms is that the modules are built as one connected record. Each module finishes its work by handing a fixed, approved result to the next. The plan is built from accepted needs and held to the budget. A requisition draws on a plan line and reserves its money. A tender is built from that requisition, and the published tender becomes the exact form every supplier answers, the rule book the evaluators apply and the basis of the contract. Nothing is retyped, and every decision points back to the one it relied on.

Running through every module are one model of authority, guided work, a record that builds itself and oversight from above. They are described at the end of this note.

How the modules fit together

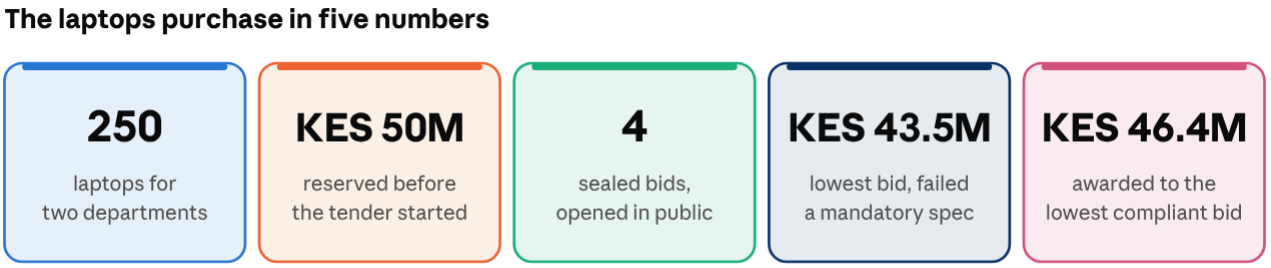


KenTender modules and what each hands to the next

The main chain runs from a department's need to the contract. Strategy and Budget feed it from the side: every plan item serves a strategic objective, and the budget is checked at planning, held at requisition and committed at contract.

The journey: 250 laptops for the Ministry of Health

The Ministry of Health needs 250 business laptops: 100 for clinical training in Human Resources and 150 for field work in Digital Health. Four suppliers compete, and the award goes to Afya Digital Supplies Limited for KES 46.4 million. Each module below does its part and passes a settled result to the next.



The laptops purchase at a glance

Strategy

The Ministry's strategic plan sets out its pillars, objectives, indicators and targets. One objective is "Strengthen interoperable national digital health services". An author drafts the plan and a separate approver makes it active.

Delivers: the active objectives that every planned purchase must name.

> **Value:** The strategic plan is where the entity commits to its share of the national development goals in Kenya Vision 2030 and the Medium-Term Plans. Tying every purchase to an objective in that plan lets the entity show how its spending advances those national goals, not just that the spending happened.

Departmental Needs

Each department states what it needs, in what quantity and by when, without a price. The Head of Human Resources sends the training request back once to confirm the number of trainees, then accepts it at 100 laptops. Digital Health's request for 150 is accepted by its acting head.

Delivers: accepted needs, ready to be planned.

> **Value:** Public money goes on what the entity actually needs. Every purchase starts from a confirmed requirement with a named owner, so the entity avoids buying what no department asked for and can show who needed each item and why the quantity is right.

Budget and Funding

The Budget Officer registers the allocation approved in the national budget process, KES 290 million for the year, and a Budget Approver checks it. KenTender does not set the budget; it holds the approved figure and tracks what is reserved, committed and still available against each budget line.

Delivers: budget lines with a live available balance, which Planning and Requisitions draw on.

> **Value:** The entity cannot commit money it does not have, which prevents pending bills and stalled contracts. Finance and procurement work from the same live figure instead of reconciling separate records.

Procurement Planning

The Procurement Planner combines the accepted needs into the Annual Procurement Plan: 14 purchases worth KES 236.5 million. The laptops become one plan item serving both departments. The plan is checked live against the budget lines, Finance confirms the funding, the Head of Procurement Function signs, and the Accounting Officer adopts it before it goes for statutory approval. If a line runs over, the planner can ask the Budget Officer for a revision from inside the system.

Delivers: approved plan items, each with its objective, method, budget line and value, ready to be requisitioned.

> **Value:** One approved, affordable plan becomes the entity's mandate to buy, so compliance is built in from the start rather than checked afterwards. Unplanned or unaffordable purchases are stopped before they start, and the plan can be defended line by line.

Requisitions

When it is time to buy, the user department raises a requisition against the laptops plan item. Its head certifies it and the Head of Procurement Function authorises it. At the moment of authorisation, KES 50 million is reserved on the two departments' budget lines

(KES 20 million for Human Resources and KES 30 million for Digital Health) and drawn down from the plan item.

Delivers: an authorised requisition with its money held, which starts tender preparation.

> **Value:** No tender can start unless a planned, certified and funded requirement stands behind it. The money is reserved and the plan is drawn down in the same step, so the entity never goes to market for something it cannot afford, and a purchase cannot be split or repeated to slip past the plan.

Tenders

The Procurement Officer prepares the tender from the authorised requisition, using the standard tender document for IT equipment. The requirements, the eleven mandatory technical specifications, the evaluation method and the contract terms all come from the requisition and the template. The Head of Procurement Function returns the first draft for a correction and approves the second. The Accounting Officer authorises publication, and a later deadline change is issued as a formal addendum.

Delivers: one published tender. From it the system generates the supplier's response form, the evaluation rules and the contract obligations.

> **Value:** Clear, reviewed rules fixed before bidding mean fewer disputes and fewer re-tenders. They also close common routes to malpractice: a specification cannot name a brand without allowing an equivalent, and a change of substance cannot be slipped in as an addendum. Because the same rules drive the bids, the evaluation and the contract, nothing is lost or reinterpreted between stages.

Supplier Portal and Bids

Suppliers register, then answer the published tender in a structured bid: offered models, compliance with each requirement, evidence, tender security and price. Each supplier's staff can prepare a bid, but only its authorised signatory can submit it. Four bids arrive before the deadline and are sealed.

Delivers: four sealed bids, with receipts, to the opening.

> **Value:** Bids arrive complete and directly comparable, which shortens evaluation. Because no one can see a price before the opening, there is no opportunity to leak a figure to a favoured bidder, and the entity and its officers are protected from any suggestion that it happened.

Bid Opening

The Accounting Officer appoints the opening committee, with an independent member. At the opening, the four totals are read out directly from the sealed bids. The lowest is Pwani Tech at KES 43.5 million. When Afya's representative asks for his figure to be repeated, the request goes into the minutes, and the members sign the record.

Delivers: the opened bids and the signed opening record, to evaluation.

> **Value:** The opening is transparent and beyond dispute. Bidders and the public see exactly what was submitted, and the signed record answers any later claim about what happened in the room.

Evaluation

The evaluation committee, appointed by the Accounting Officer, declares any conflict before seeing a bid. It then applies the published method. Pwani's lowest bid fails a mandatory requirement, 8 GB of memory against 16 GB. Mlima Computer Solutions fails eligibility on an expired tax compliance certificate. Afya ranks first at KES 46.4 million and Jirani second at KES 48.72 million. All three members sign the report.

Delivers: the signed evaluation report and recommendation, to the Head of Procurement Function.

> **Value:** Outcomes are predictable and defensible, with little room for discretion to be abused. Conflicts are declared before anyone sees a bid, and mandatory requirements cannot be waived. A losing bidder can see exactly why, which reduces complaints and puts the entity on firm ground if the result is challenged.

Award

The Head of Procurement Function signs a professional opinion recommending Afya. The Accounting Officer reviews the report, the opinion and the draft notices together, and awards. All four bidders are notified at once, Afya accepts the next morning, and the system holds the award until the standstill period ends.

Delivers: a complete award package, with the decision, the notices, the acceptance and the contract obligations from the tender, to Contract Management.

> **Value:** The Accounting Officer can decide with confidence, because the decision rests on a complete, signed evidence trail in which no step can be skipped or reordered. Every decision is fully auditable, and the award cannot be steered to a supplier the evidence does not support.

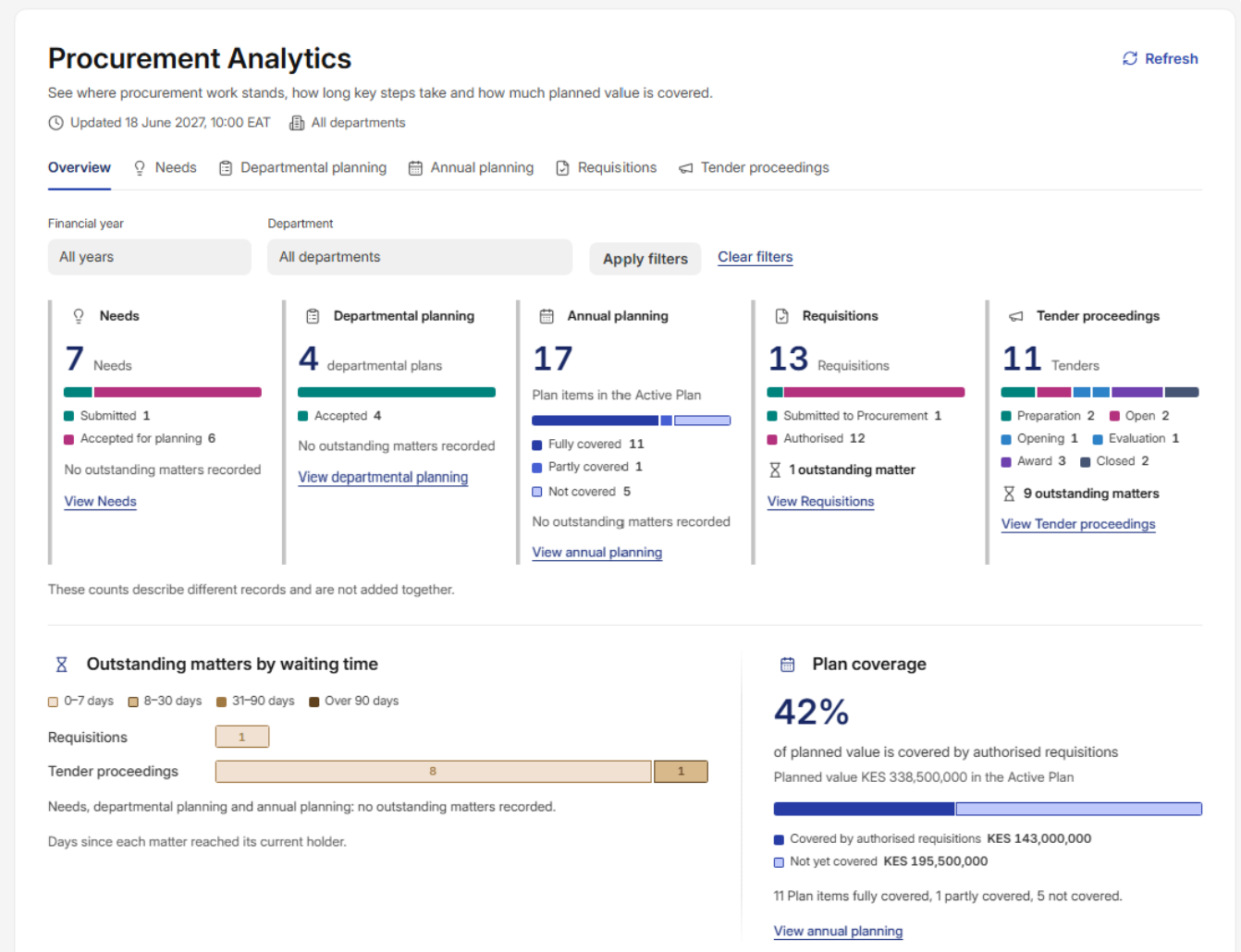
Next: Contract Management

The chain continues into the contract: signing, the performance security, delivery, inspection and acceptance, invoices and payment, variations, and close-out. It receives the award package, so the contract starts from the same obligations the supplier bid against, and the money reserved at requisition becomes a contract commitment.

Procurement Analytics: the chain, measured

Because every module writes to the same connected record, KenTender can measure the whole procurement function as it runs. Procurement Analytics reads those records live; nothing is compiled by hand or reconciled from separate reports. It answers three questions for the Accounting Officer and management: where does the work stand, how long do key steps take, and how much of the plan is being delivered. The screens below show the Ministry of Health demonstration data as at 18 June 2027.

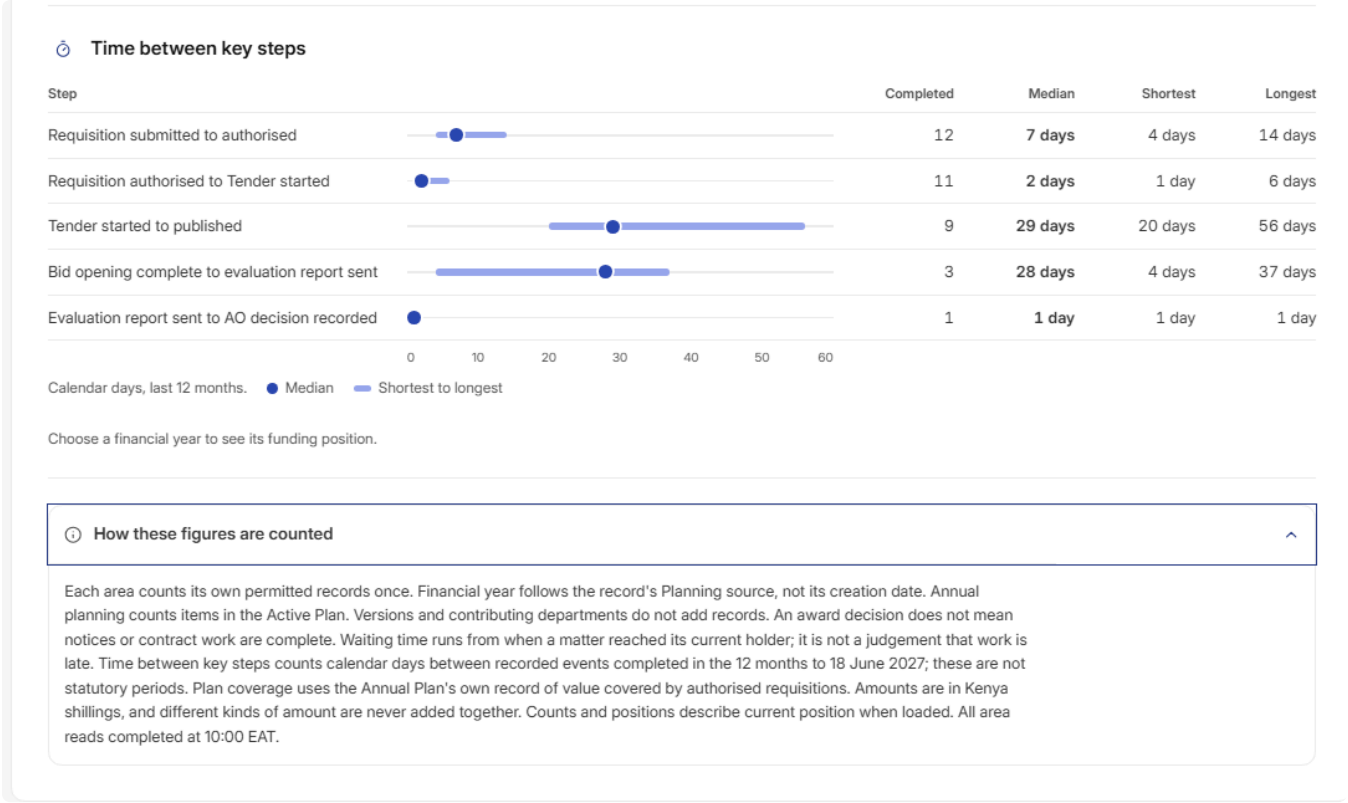
Overview: the whole pipeline on one page



What it shows. One card per stage of the chain, each with its count and current states: 7 needs, 4 departmental plans, 17 plan items, 13 requisitions, and 11 tenders at stages from preparation to closed. Below, every outstanding matter is grouped by how long it has waited with its current holder, from under a week to over 90 days. Here, 9 of the 10 open matters sit with tender proceedings. Plan coverage shows how much of the planned value is already backed by authorised requisitions: 42% of KES 338.5 million across all years.

Why it is there. The Accounting Officer sees in a minute where procurement is moving and where it is stuck, without asking each office for an update. It supports efficiency and transparency: a backlog is visible as soon as it forms, along with who holds it.

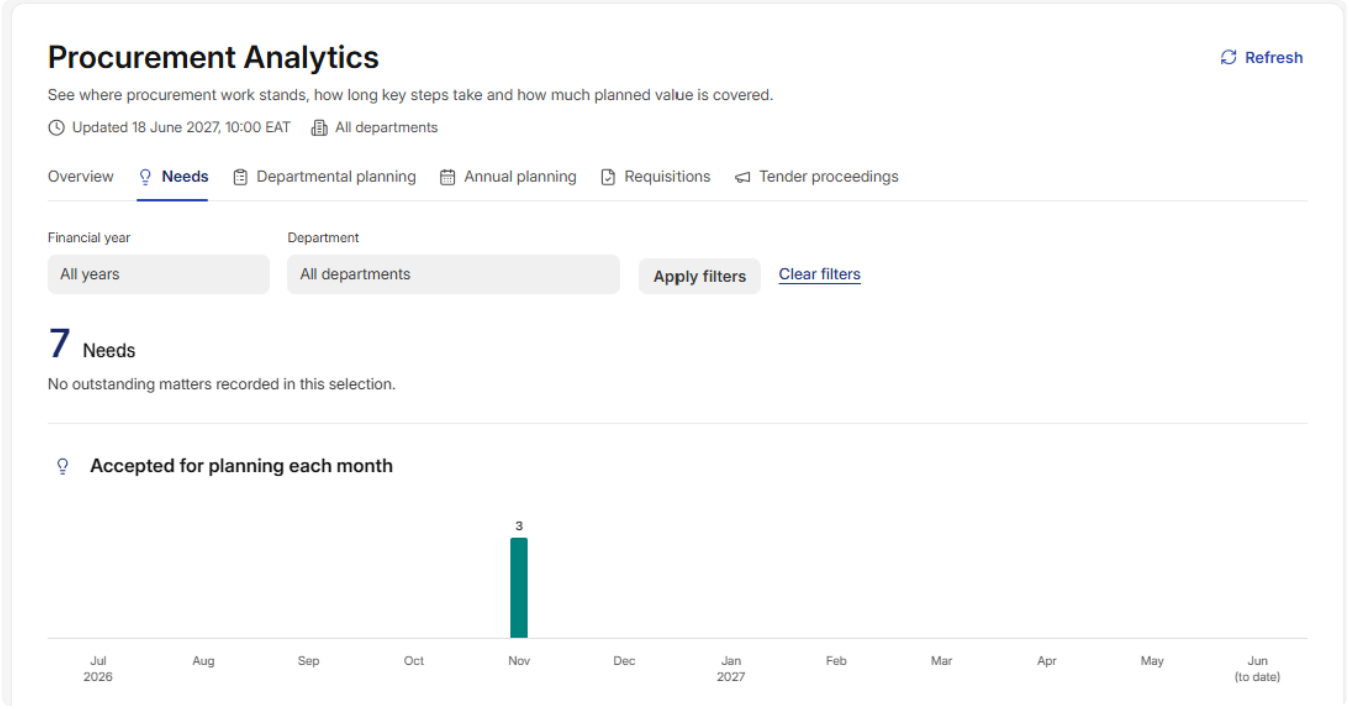
Time between key steps: where the time goes



What it shows. For each step in the chain, how many were completed in the last 12 months and how long they took: the median, the shortest and the longest. A requisition takes a median of 7 days to authorise. Preparing a tender for publication takes 29 days but ranges from 20 to 56. An evaluation takes 28 days, ranging from 4 to 37. An open panel explains exactly how each figure is counted. For example, waiting time is not a judgement that work is late, and these are not statutory periods.

Why it is there. Bottlenecks are measured rather than argued about. A wide range shows a step that is unpredictable, which is often where process improvement or training pays off. Because the counting rules are stated on the page, the figures can be relied on in management reports and audit discussions.

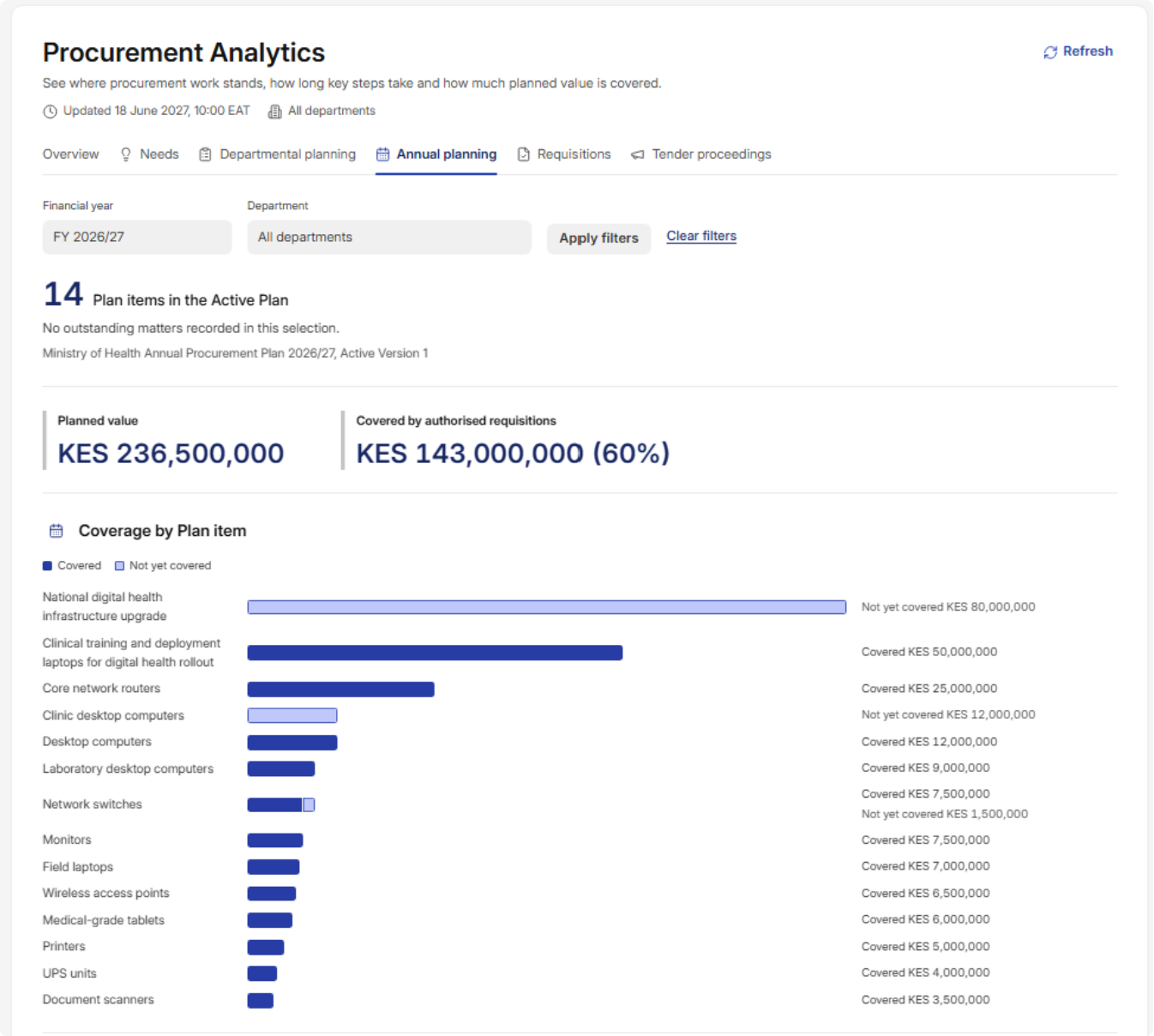
Needs: demand as it arrives



What it shows. How many departmental needs are in the system and when they were accepted for planning, month by month. In this example, three needs were accepted in November 2026, ahead of the next annual planning round.

Why it is there. It shows whether departments are bringing their requirements in time for planning, so late or missing demand can be chased before the plan is set.

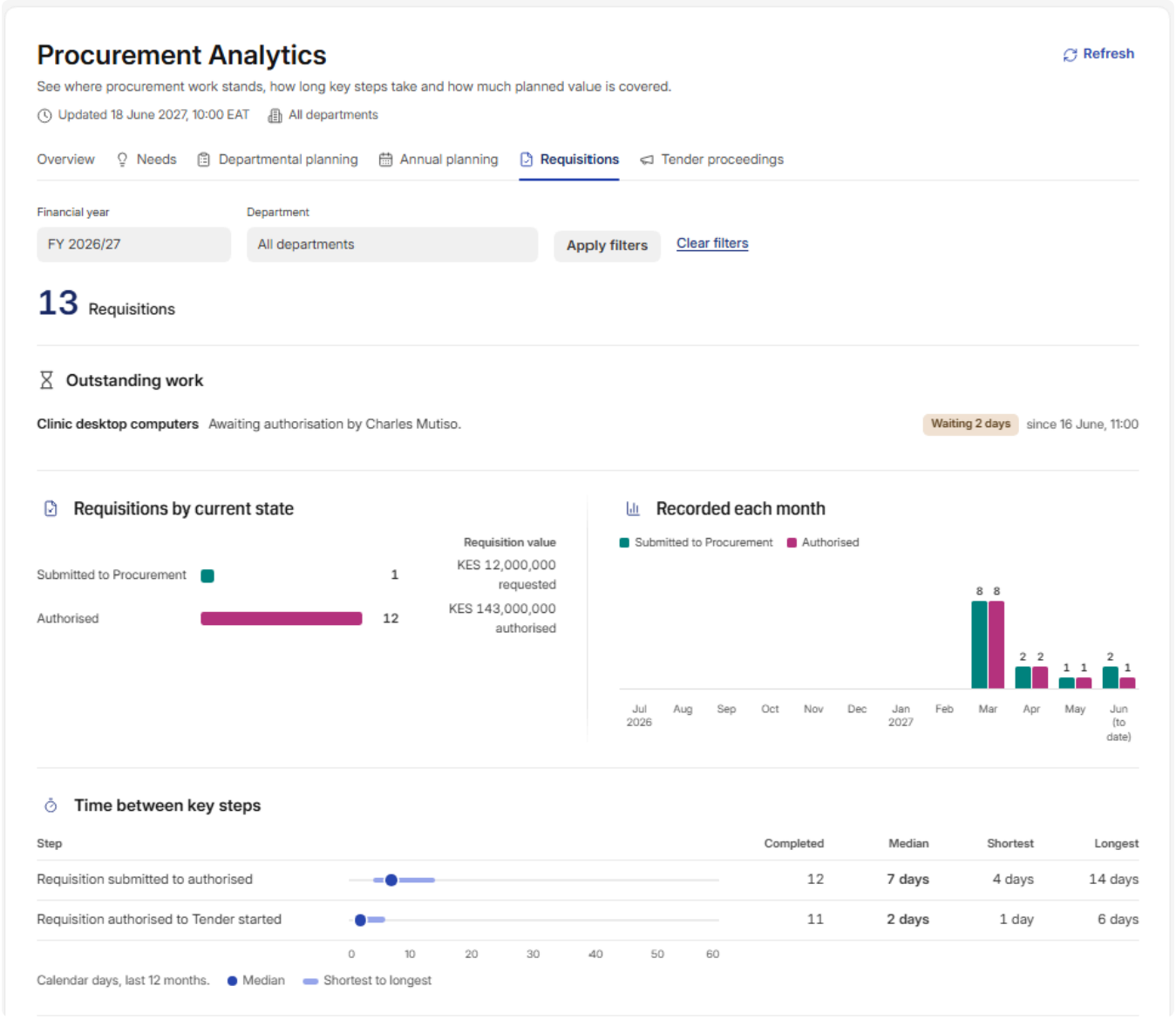
Annual planning: is the plan being delivered?



What it shows. For FY 2026/27, the Active Plan holds 14 items worth KES 236.5 million, of which KES 143 million (60%) is covered by authorised requisitions. Coverage is then broken down item by item. The largest item, the KES 80 million national digital health infrastructure upgrade, has not started. Network switches are partly covered.

Why it is there. The plan is the entity's commitment, and this view shows whether it is being delivered and which items are at risk of not happening this year. It links procurement execution directly to the strategy and the budget that sit behind the plan.

Requisitions: authority to buy, in motion



What it shows. 13 requisitions for the year: 12 authorised, worth KES 143 million, and 1 worth KES 12 million awaiting authorisation. The outstanding item names who holds it and for how long: the clinic desktop computers, waiting 2 days with Charles Mutiso. Monthly activity shows the March peak, when 8 requisitions were submitted and authorised. The time each step took is shown underneath.

Why it is there. Value waiting for a decision is visible together with the person who must make it. Seasonal peaks show when procurement capacity will be stretched, so the entity can plan for them.

The same views are available for departmental planning and tender proceedings. Every view can be filtered by financial year and department, and each figure opens the records behind it.

What runs through every module

One model of authority. One KenTender site serves one procuring entity. Each person holds named responsibilities, such as Head of User Department for a directorate, Head of Procurement Function or Accounting Officer, for a stated part of the organisation and a stated period. Committees are appointed for one tender only. Every module asks the same question before it acts: does this person hold this responsibility, for this record, now? The same check stops one person from both preparing and approving the same thing.

Guided work. Every record tells the person looking at it where it stands, whose turn it is and, if it is stuck, why and who can fix it. Each person's home page gathers what is waiting for them across all modules, what they are waiting on from others, and what they recently completed. Work does not stall unseen on a desk.

A record that builds itself. Every decision is kept with who made it, in what role, when and why, including every return and every earlier version. Any purchase can be followed from its award back through evaluation, opening, tender, requisition, plan, need and budget to the strategy it serves.

Oversight from above. Each person's home page and Procurement Analytics read the same chain for management. Every figure traces back to the records and decisions that produced it.